RIYADH · DAMMAM · SAUDI ARABIA

17 OCTOBER 2026

Saudi Airports Status

Incident summary and airport deep dives · as of 8:52 AM, Saturday 17 October 2026, Riyadh time (UTC+3)

Riyadh airport **Halted** · 18 cancelled today | Dammam airport **Disrupted** · 21 cancelled

Riyadh airport halted since 9:29 PM Sunday, 7,891 minutes at 9:00 AM; Dammam moving, latest takeoff Gulf Air GF102 to Bahrain at 8:42 AM

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INCIDENT SUMMARY

What is happening now, at both airports and across the Kingdom.

HEADLINE

- **Riyadh airport halted since 9:29 PM Sunday, 7,891 minutes at 9:00 AM; NOTAM A3604/26 keeps it closed until 12:00 AM Sunday 18 Oct, and GACA has not announced a reopening**.
- No Riyadh takeoff or landing in the last hour; 18 flights cancelled so far for Saturday (14% of scheduled).
- UK Foreign Office now advises against all but essential travel to Saudi Arabia and tells Britons to stay away from King Khalid airport.
- No new attack, intercept or Civil Defense attack alert on official Saudi accounts since the 8:00 AM edition; Civil Defense warns of thunderstorms until Wednesday.
- Dammam moving with no halt open: 2 takeoffs and 1 landing in the last hour, latest Gulf Air GF102 to Bahrain at 8:42 AM.

RIYADH AIRPORT RUH

HALTED

No takeoff or landing since 9:29 PM (7883 min).

18	0/0	0
CANCELLED TODAY	TAKEOFFS/LANDINGS, 1H	DIVERTED

DAMMAM AIRPORT DMM

DISRUPTED

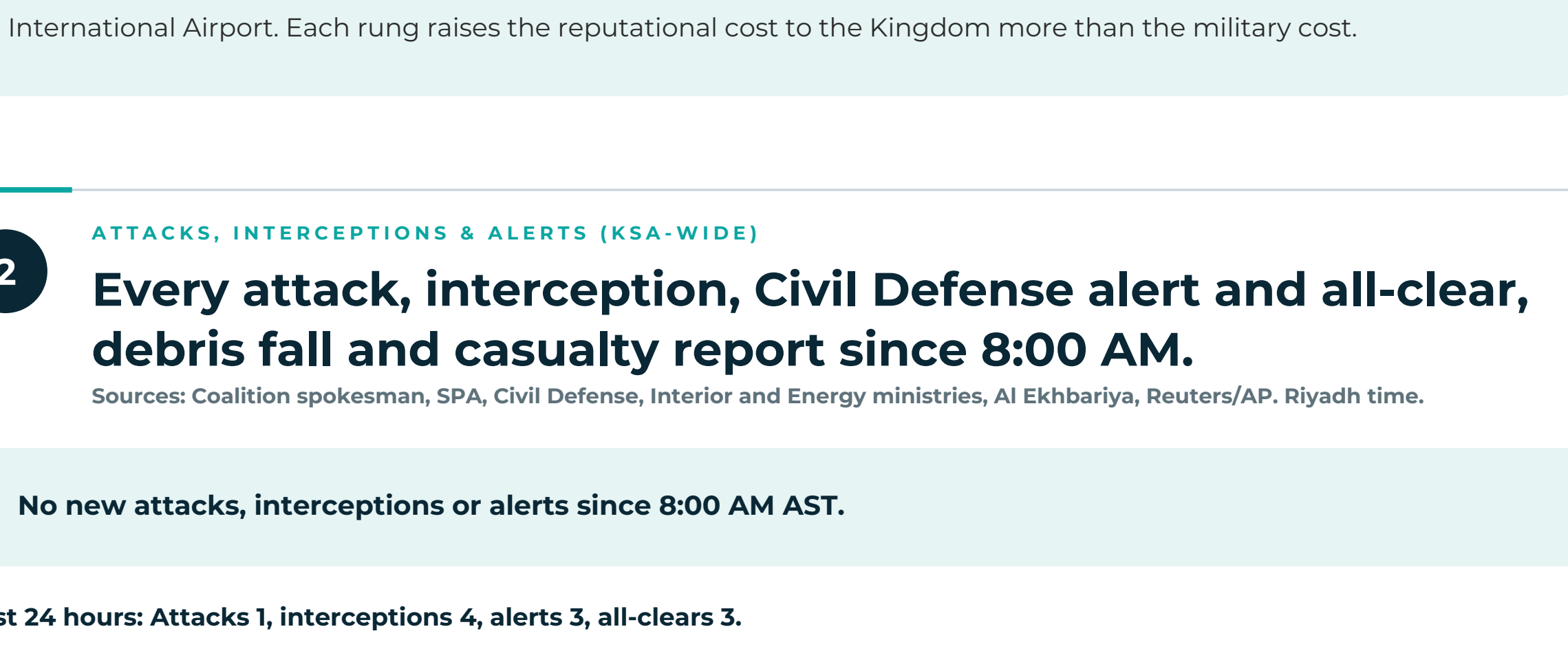
2 takeoffs and 1 landing in the last hour.

21	2/1	0
CANCELLED TODAY	TAKEOFFS/LANDINGS, 1H	DIVERTED

WHAT CHANGED IN THE LAST HOUR

- Riyadh still halted since 9:29 PM Sunday (7,891 min at 9:00 AM)
- Dammam moving with no halt open: 2 takeoffs (F3461, GF102) and 1 landing (XY402) in the last hour
- UK FCDO now advises against all but essential travel to Saudi Arabia (gov.uk, updated 16 Oct)

ESCALATION PATTERN: HOUTHI STRIKES ON KSA BY TARGET TYPE, 8 SEP – 17 OCT



45 sourced events since 8 September (39 confirmed). Latest: Coalition: three UAVs intercepted and destroyed in the southern and Riyadh regions (16 Oct, Coalition spokesman / SPA; none reported (intercept)). Each event has a source link in strikes.json and on the website. Filled = confirmed officially; amber = reported by credible media; hollow = claimed only (Houthi or unattributed). Events without a source are not plotted.

SO WHAT

The campaign has climbed an escalation ladder: from military targets to economic targets (Aramco, Yanbu), then to symbolic targets (the Madinah power station serving the Prophet's Mosque), and now to civilian aviation and the capital. King Khalid International Airport has been hit or targeted on 19 Sep, 5, 7, 8, 10 and 11 Oct; the 10–11 Oct strikes closed it indefinitely. On the evening of 11 Oct GACA confirmed a further attack on Dammam's King Fahd International Airport. Each rung raises the reputational cost to the Kingdom more than the military cost.

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ATTACKS, INTERCEPTIONS & ALERTS (KSA-WIDE)

Every attack, interception, Civil Defense alert and all-clear, debris fall and casualty report since 8:00 AM.

Sources: Coalition spokesman, SPA, Civil Defense, Interior and Energy ministries, Al Ekhbariya, Reuters/AP. Riyadh time.

No new attacks, interceptions or alerts since 8:00 AM AST.

Last 24 hours: Attacks 1, interceptions 4, alerts 3, all-clears 3.

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NEWS AND STATEMENTS

Riyadh still halted 15 hours before the NOTAM's planned reopening; UK tightens its Saudi travel advice

Checked at 8:58 AM: Reuters, AP, AFP, Arab News, SPA, GACA, Flightradar24 on X. Times are publication or post times, Riyadh time.

CONFIRMED **Civil Defense urges caution as thunderstorms continue over most regions until Wednesday**

Al Ekhbariya (@alekhbariyatv) · 8:45 AM · published 8:45 AM AST Sat 17 Oct (official Saudi channel, translated from Arabic); weather alert, not an attack alert; checked 8:58 AM

Saudi state channel Al Ekhbariya reports that the General Directorate of Civil Defense is calling on residents to take care as thunderstorms continue over most regions of the Kingdom until next Wednesday.

UNVERIFIED DMM **Social accounts report explosions heard around Dammam and fires at Eastern Province oil facilities overnight**

X (@TomthunkitsMind, @AlhryaWaltaghyr, @osinthexagone) · 7:33 AM · Posted 6:43-7:33 AM AST Sat 17 Oct; no Civil Defense alert for Dammam, SPA, Ministry of Defense or Aramco statement found; checked 7:58 AM

Several social accounts, some Houthi-aligned, say explosions were heard around Dammam overnight and that fires are burning at oil facilities in the Eastern Province; one OSINT account shared unverified footage of a possible ballistic missile impact at an unknown Eastern Province location and said the situation at King Fahd International Airport appears to be over. No official Saudi channel has confirmed an attack, intercept or impact. Dammam airport resumed movements at 7:17 AM.

CONFIRMED **SPA: Weather service forecasts moderate to heavy thunderstorms in the southwest and fog on the Eastern Province coast**

SPA (@SPAregions) · 7:00 AM · published 7:00 AM AST Sat 17 Oct (official account, translated from Arabic); checked 7:58 AM

The National Center for Meteorology forecasts moderate to heavy thunderstorms with flash flooding, hail and strong winds over Jazan, Asir, Al Baha and Makkah, with fog forming, including over coastal parts of Madinah and the Eastern Province.

UNVERIFIED **Air India reported to cancel all flights to and from Riyadh, Dammam and Jeddah until 20 October**

Makkah Updates (@MakkahUpdate) · 6:26 AM · Single social account; no Air India statement found yet

Makkah Updates says Air India has cancelled all flights to and from Riyadh, Dammam and Jeddah until 20 October, with full refunds offered. Air India has not been seen confirming this yet.

CONFIRMED **UK Foreign Office now advises against all but essential travel to Saudi Arabia**

UK FCDO (gov.uk) · 16 Oct · gov.uk travel advice updated 16 Oct, still current 17 Oct; first relayed on X 5:40 AM; checked 8:58 AM

The FCDO's Saudi Arabia page now advises against all but essential travel to the whole country and all travel within 10 km of the Yemen border. It tells British nationals to stay away from King Khalid International Airport until it is secure and says further attacks on airports are very likely; it suggests leaving by land to a neighbouring country as an alternative to Saudi airports.

UNVERIFIED **EU-GCC summit planned in Riyadh reported postponed amid Houthi strikes**

5W1H Brief (@5w1hbrief) · 6:16 AM · posted 6:16 AM AST Sat 17 Oct, citing unnamed reports; no official GCC or EU statement checked; checked 6:20 AM

A news-summary account reported that the EU-Gulf Cooperation Council summit planned in Riyadh has been postponed, with a new date to be announced later. No official GCC or European Council statement has been seen yet.

CONFIRMED **Al Ekhbariya: Yemen's Transport Ministry condemns the Houthi militia's second attack on Aden International Airport**

Al Ekhbariya (@alekhbariyatv) · 5:50 AM · published 5:50 AM AST Sat 17 Oct (official Saudi channel, Arabic, translated); checked 6:20 AM

Saudi state channel Al Ekhbariya reported that Yemen's Ministry of Transport condemned the Houthi militia for targeting Aden International Airport for the second time.

UNVERIFIED **Gulf Business: several airlines extend Saudi suspensions into next week as Riyadh's closure deadline nears**

Gulf Business · Sat AM · Article dated Sat 17 Oct, exact publish time not shown; checked 8:58 AM

Gulf Business says cancellations continue across Saudi Arabia on Saturday and that several airlines have extended suspensions beyond 17 October. It notes the NOTAM deadline of 12:00 AM Sunday Riyadh time is not a confirmed reopening, and cites the coalition's figure of 20 attacks on King Khalid airport this month, with 17 killed and 333 injured.

CONFIRMED **Coalition says it destroyed two Houthi ballistic missile launch platforms in Saada**

SPA / Coalition spokesman Turki Al-Maliki · 4:35 AM · Statement by Brig. Gen. Turki Al-Maliki on X, carried by SPA (spa.gov.sa N2703398) and Sabq at 4:35 AM AST Sat 17 Oct; checked 7:58 AM

The Saudi-led coalition's spokesman, Brig. Gen. Turki Al-Maliki, announced that two ballistic missile launch platforms were destroyed in Yemen's Saada province. He earlier released video of coalition strikes on Houthi weapons-smuggling by sea to Hodeidah. No further operational details were given.

CONFIRMED **King Khalid airport again tells travelers to follow official authorities and their airline for airspace updates**

King Khalid Intl Airport (@KKIASA) · 3:40 AM · published 3:40 AM AST Sat 17 Oct (reply on official account, translated from Arabic); checked 3:55 AM

Replying to a traveler, King Khalid International Airport said that for the latest airspace updates people should follow the competent official authorities or their airline. It gave no reopening time.

UNVERIFIED **AGBI: Riyadh airport reopening in doubt; at least 25 airliners flown out since last Saturday**

AGBI · 3:12 PM Fri · Published 3:12 PM Friday 16 Oct; analysts split on whether the NOTAM closure is extended

AGBI reports King Khalid airport is tentatively due to reopen at midnight tonight under the NOTAM, subject to review, but experts are divided on an extension given continuing Houthi attacks. It says flight data show at least 25 commercial aircraft left the airport since last Saturday, mostly to other Saudi airports, and airlines are considering operating from other airports.

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KING KHALID INTERNATIONAL AIRPORT · RIYADH

Riyadh airport: halted. No takeoff or landing since 9:29 PM (7883 min).

18	—	—	0	0
FLIGHTS CANCELLED TODAY	LAST TAKEOFF	LAST LANDING	TAKEOFFS, LAST HOUR	ARRIVALS DIVERTED
9 departures + 9 arrivals, 14% of 125 scheduled.	None on the board.	None on the board.	0 landings in the last hour.	None recorded today.

Cancellation basis: *Flightradar24 RUH board count, departures + arrivals scheduled on the local day (midnight to midnight, Riyadh time), all pages including flights still to come, codeshares and identical rows de-duplicated; boards fetched 8:52 AM. Flightradar24's own stats panel shows 18 at 8:53 AM; the panel updates a few minutes behind the board.*

FLIGHTRADAR24 AIRPORT STATS

MEASURE	DEPARTURES	ARRIVALS	TOTAL	BASIS
Cancelled today, board count	9	9	18	FR24 boards, local day
Cancelled today, stats panel	9 (16%)	9 (13%)	18	FR24 stats panel
Delayed today	0 (0%)	0 (0%)	0	FR24 stats panel
On time today (share of operated)	0 (0%)	8 (100%)	8	FR24 stats panel
Average delay, recent flights	0 min	0 min	—	FR24 stats panel
Operated since midnight vs scheduled so far	0 of 18	0 of 31	0 of 49	FR24 boards
Diverted today	—	0	0	FR24 arrivals board
Already cancelled tomorrow	139	123	262	FR24 stats panel
Cancelled yesterday (for scale)	98	87	185	FR24 stats panel

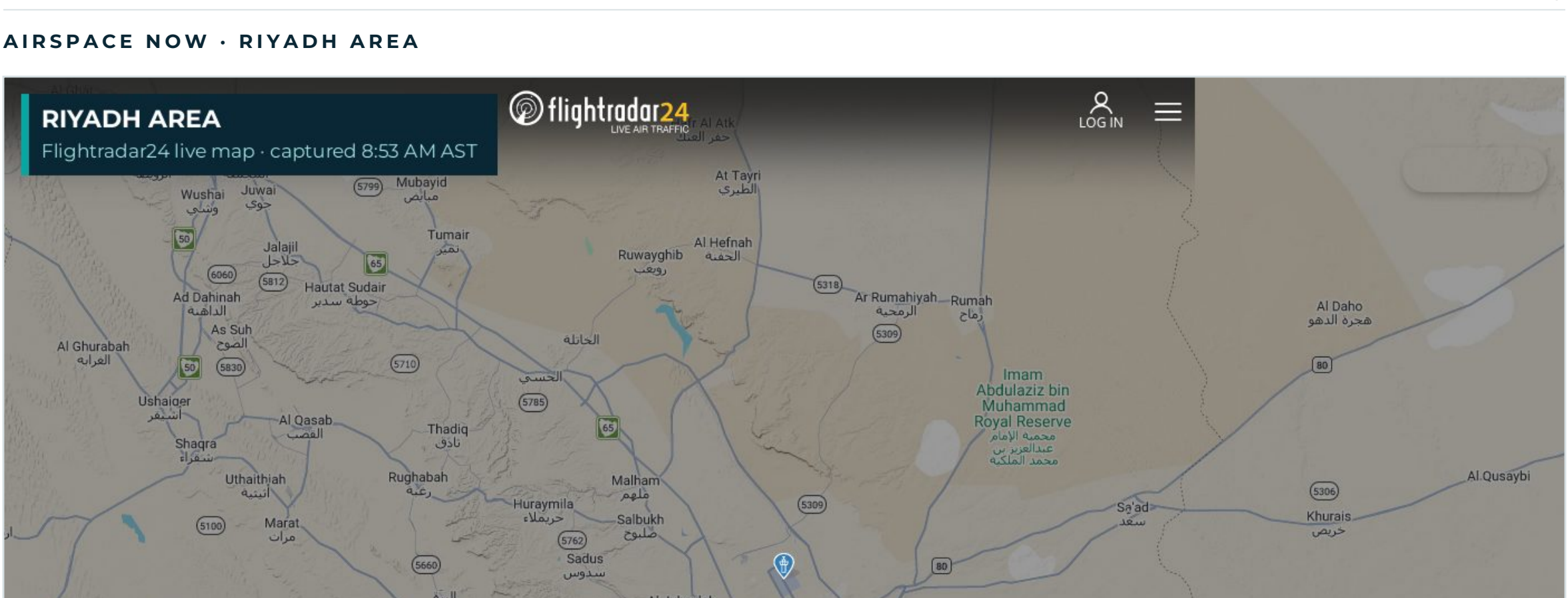
CANCELLATIONS BY AIRLINE, TOP 5

Royal Jordanian	6
Saudia	5
airblue	3
Badr Airlines	2
flyadeal	1

MOST-CANCELLED ROUTES, TOP 5

Amman	4
Lahore	2
Port Sudan	2
Aqaba	2
Madinah	2

TAKEOFFS AND LANDINGS PER HOUR, LAST 24 HOURS · RUH



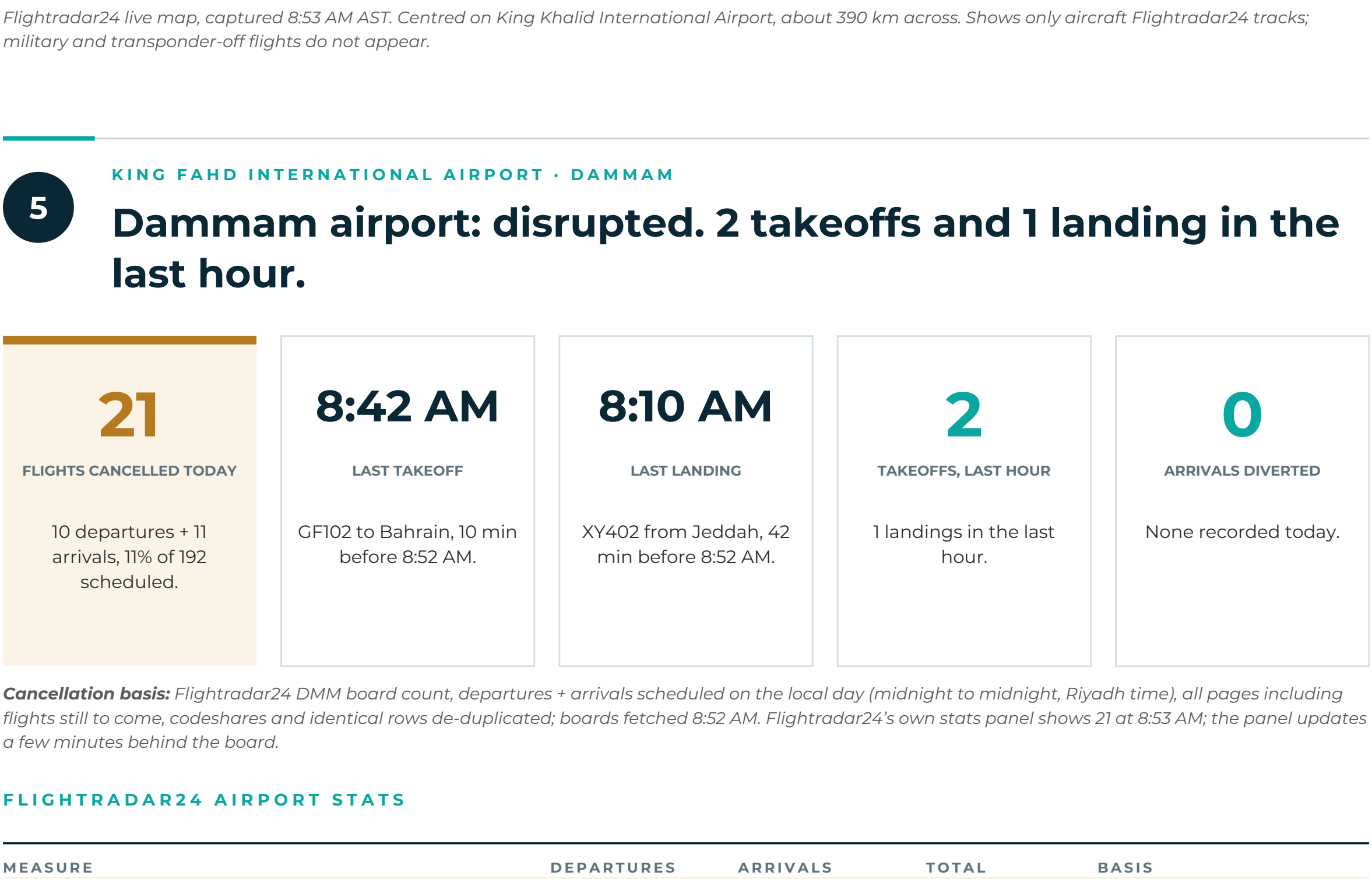
Recorded takeoffs (0) and landings (0) at RUH per hour from 9:00 AM Friday to 8:52 AM, Riyadh time; the newest bar is the current, partial hour. × marks flights cancelled, at their scheduled time. Gray boxes are halts: 45 minutes or more with no takeoff or landing on the board, kept until they roll out of the window. Source: Flightradar24 RUH departures and arrivals boards, fetched read-only.

Gray boxes mark halts of 45 minutes or more with no takeoff or landing, worked out from the Flightradar24 board and kept until they roll out of the 24-hour window. Riyadh's open halt since 9:29 PM Sunday covers the whole window, with no Riyadh movement in it. Dammam's halts in the window ran 8:23–9:38 AM, 4:10–5:13 PM and 5:44–7:14 PM Friday, then 11:32 PM–12:18 AM, 12:27–1:40 AM, 1:50–2:41 AM, 3:06–4:21 AM, 4:31–5:27 AM and 5:27–7:17 AM; Dammam has been moving since Saudia SV118 landed from London at 7:17 AM, with no halt open; its latest movement was Gulf Air GF102 to Bahrain at 8:42 AM.

HALTS IN THE LAST 24 HOURS

OPEN Halt since 9:29 PM	7883 min and counting

AIRSPACE NOW · RIYADH AREA


RIYADH AREA

Flightradar24 live map · captured 8:53 AM AST

Flightradar24 live map, captured 8:53 AM AST. Centred on King Khalid International Airport, about 390 km across. Shows only aircraft Flightradar24 tracks; military and transponder-off flights do not appear.

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KING FAHD INTERNATIONAL AIRPORT · DAMMAM

Dammam airport: disrupted. 2 takeoffs and 1 landing in the last hour.

21	8:42 AM	8:10 AM	2	0
FLIGHTS CANCELLED TODAY	LAST TAKEOFF	LAST LANDING	TAKEOFFS, LAST HOUR	ARRIVALS DIVERTED
10 departures + 11 arrivals, 11% of 192 scheduled.	GF102 to Bahrain, 10 min before 8:52 AM.	XY402 from Jeddah, 42 min before 8:52 AM.	1 landings in the last hour.	None recorded today.

Cancellation basis: *Flightradar24 DMM board count, departures + arrivals scheduled on the local day (midnight to midnight, Riyadh time), all pages including flights still to come, codeshares and identical rows de-duplicated; boards fetched 8:52 AM. Flightradar24's own stats panel shows 21 at 8:53 AM; the panel updates a few minutes behind the board.*

FLIGHTRADAR24 AIRPORT STATS

MEASURE	DEPARTURES	ARRIVALS	TOTAL	BASIS
Cancelled today, board count	10	11	21	FR24 boards, local day
Cancelled today, stats panel	10 (10%)	11 (11%)	21	FR24 stats panel
Delayed today	9 (9%)	6 (6%)	15	FR24 stats panel
On time today (share of operated)	5 (36%)	9 (60%)	14	FR24 stats panel
Average delay, recent flights	26 min	0 min	—	FR24 stats panel
Operated since midnight vs scheduled so far	12 of 23	13 of 25	25 of 48	FR24 boards
Diverted today	—	0	0	FR24 arrivals board
Already cancelled tomorrow	18	18	36	FR24 stats panel
Cancelled yesterday (for scale)	31	37	68	FR24 stats panel

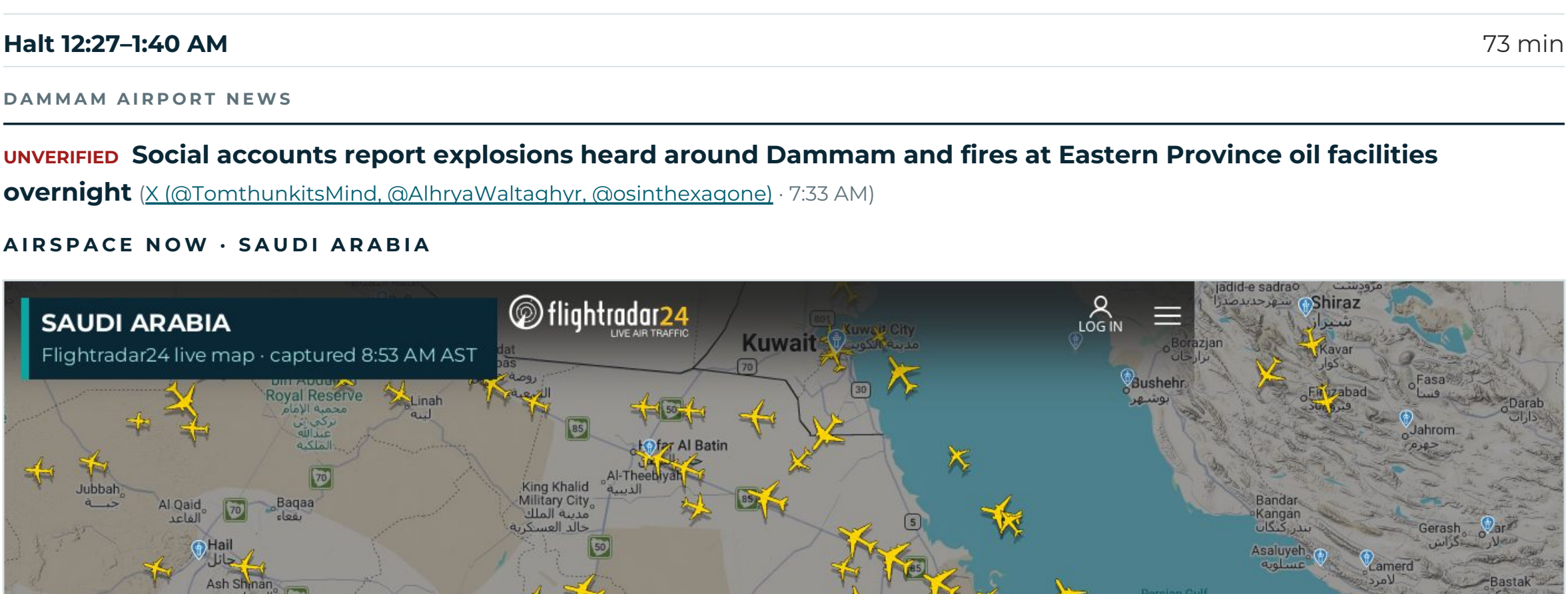
CANCELLATIONS BY AIRLINE, TOP 5

Egyptair	8
flyadeal	4
Saudia	4
Turkish Airlines	2
Royal Jordanian	2

MOST-CANCELLED ROUTES, TOP 5

Jeddah	8
Cairo	6
Istanbul	2
Amman	2
Alexandria	2

TAKEOFFS AND LANDINGS PER HOUR, LAST 24 HOURS · DMM



Recorded takeoffs (55) and landings (53) at DMM per hour from 9:00 AM Friday to 8:52 AM, Riyadh time; the newest bar is the current, partial hour. × marks flights cancelled, at their scheduled time. Gray boxes are halts: 45 minutes or more with no takeoff or landing on the board, kept until they roll out of the window. Source: Flightradar24 DMM departures and arrivals boards, fetched read-only.

No halt open; last halt 5:27 to 7:17 AM (109 min). 2 takeoffs and 1 landing in the last hour.

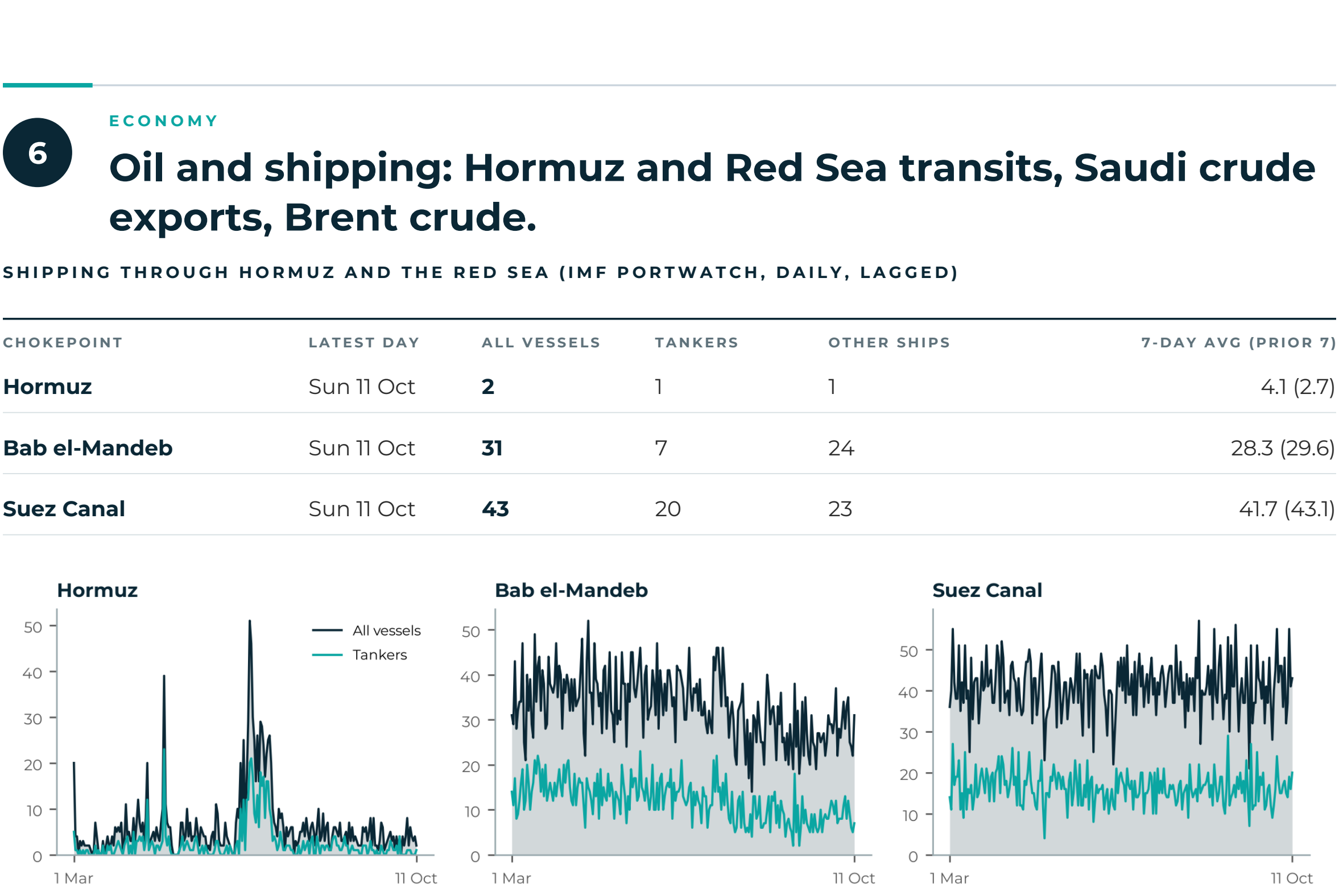
HALTS IN THE LAST 24 HOURS

Halt 5:27–7:17 AM	109 min
Halt 4:31–5:27 AM	56 min
Halt 3:06–4:21 AM	76 min
Halt 1:50–2:41 AM	51 min
Halt 12:27–1:40 AM	73 min

DAMMAM AIRPORT NEWS

UNVERIFIED **Social accounts report explosions heard around Dammam and fires at Eastern Province oil facilities overnight** (X (@TomthunkitsMind, @AlhryaWaltaghyr, @osinthexagone) · 7:33 AM)

AIRSPACE NOW · SAUDI ARABIA


SAUDI ARABIA

Flightradar24 live map · captured 8:53 AM AST

Flightradar24 live map, captured 8:53 AM AST. Regional view: central and eastern Saudi Arabia including Dammam, the Gulf, Bahrain, Qatar and the UAE coast (no Dammam-only view is captured). Shows only aircraft Flightradar24 tracks; military and transponder-off flights do not appear.

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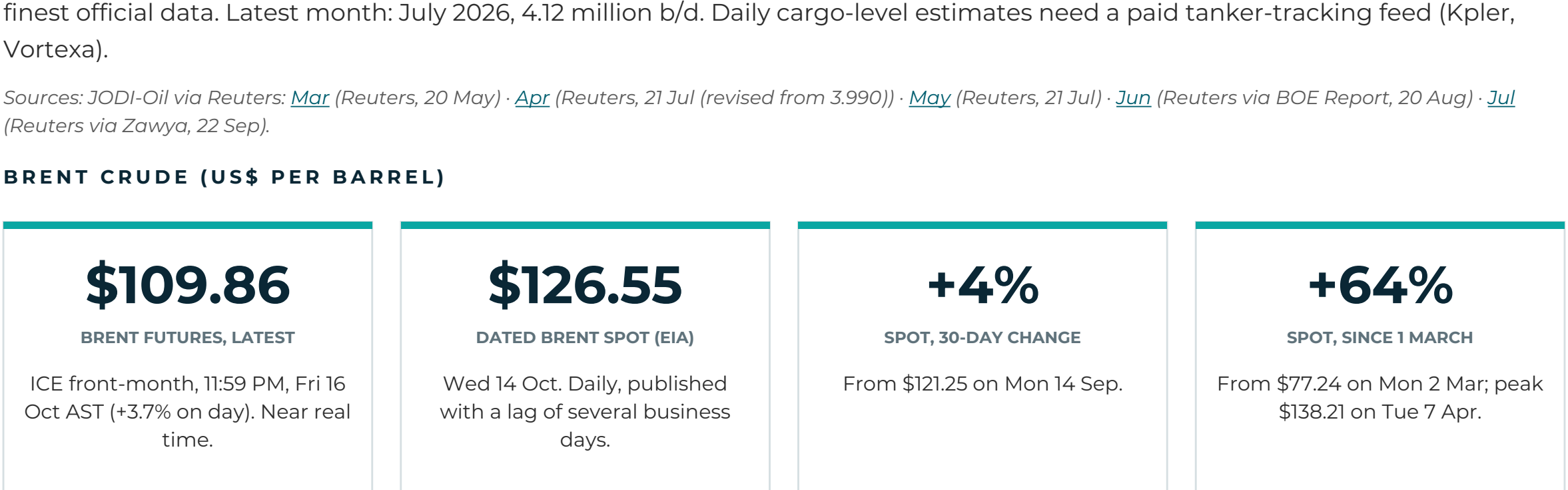
ECONOMY

Oil and shipping: Hormuz and Red Sea transits, Saudi crude exports, Brent crude.

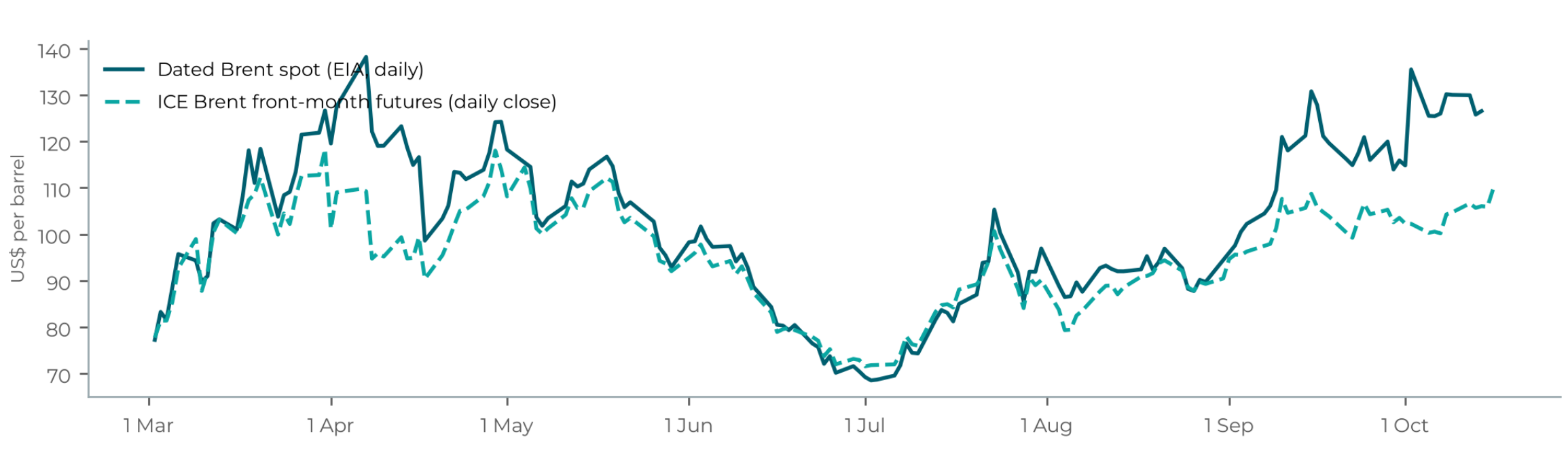
SHIPPING THROUGH HORMUZ AND THE RED SEA (IMF PORTWATCH, DAILY, LAGGED)

CHOKEPOINT	LATEST DAY	ALL VESSELS	TANKERS	OTHER SHIPS	7-DAY AVG (PRIOR 7)
Hormuz	Sun 11 Oct	**2**	1	1	4.1 (2.7)
Bab el-Mandeb	Sun 11 Oct	**31**	7	24	28.3 (29.6)
Suez Canal	Sun 11 Oct	**43**	20	23	41.7 (43.1)



*Source: IMF PortWatch daily chokepoint transits (AIS-based, both directions combined; PortWatch does not split inbound and outbound), since 1 March 2026. **Daily, lagged about 4 to 7 days.** Fetched 8:53 AM, Sat 17 Oct AST. Red Sea = Bab el-Mandeb (southern entrance) and Suez Canal (northern exit).*

SAUDI CRUDE OIL EXPORTS, JODI MONTHLY AVERAGE (MILLION BARRELS PER DAY)

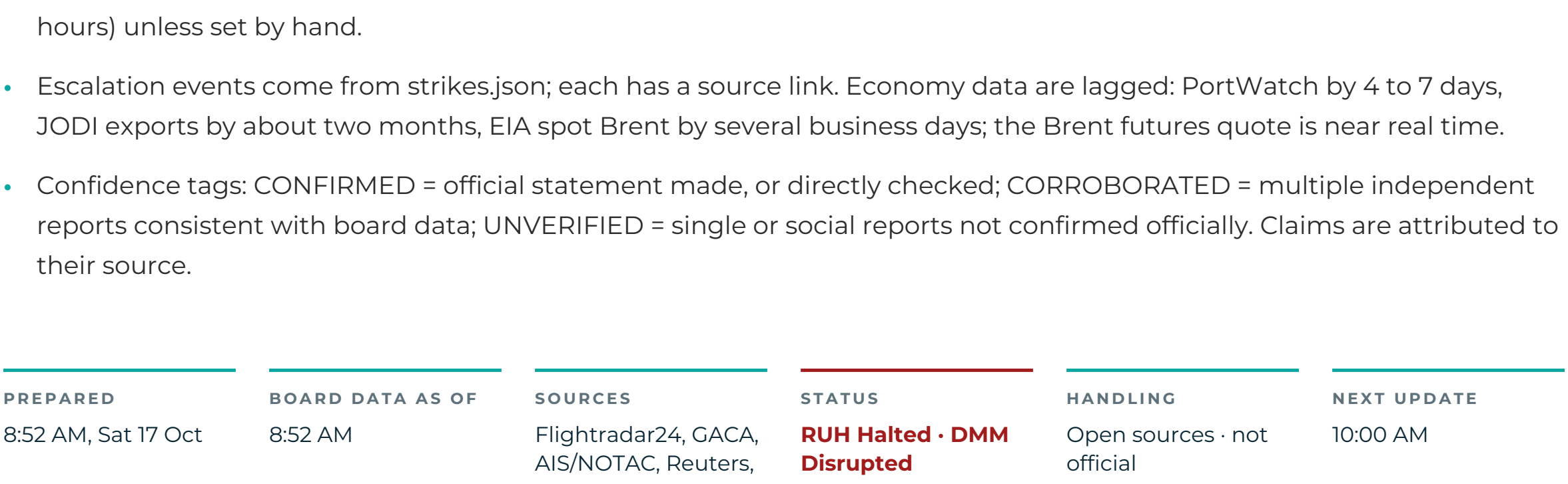


Monthly, lagged about two months. Saudi Arabia does not publish daily export figures and no free daily series exists; JODI is the finest official data. Latest month: July 2026, 4.12 million b/d. Daily cargo-level estimates need a paid tanker-tracking feed (Kpler, Vortexa).

Sources: JODI-Oil via Reuters: Mar (Reuters, 20 May) · Apr (Reuters, 21 Jul (revised from 3.990)) · May (Reuters, 21 Jul) · Jun (Reuters via BOE Report, 20 Aug) · Jul (Reuters via Zawya, 22 Sep).

BRENT CRUDE (US$ PER BARREL)

$109.86	$126.55	+4%	+64%
BRENT FUTURES, LATEST	DATED BRENT SPOT (EIA)	SPOT, 30-DAY CHANGE	SPOT, SINCE 1 MARCH
ICE front-month, 11:59 PM, Fri 16 Oct AST (+3.7% on day). Near real time.	Wed 14 Oct. Daily, published with a lag of several business days.	From $121.25 on Mon 14 Sep.	From $77.24 on Mon 2 Mar; peak $138.21 on Tue 7 Apr.



Sources: US EIA, Europe Brent Spot Price FOB (RBRTE), daily, official, lagged; ICE Brent futures (BZ=F) via Yahoo Finance, delayed quote; weekend values are Friday's close. Physical Dated Brent has traded well above futures since the Gulf disruption, so the two lines differ.

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METHOD AND LIMITS

What the numbers are, and are not.

- Airport figures (last takeoff and landing, counts, cancellations, diversions, charts, halts) come from the Flightradar24 RUH and DMM boards fetched at 8:52 AM, all pages for the local day. Flightradar24 is an unofficial aggregator, not a GACA or airport feed, and actual times can lag by a few minutes.
- Halts are computed per airport from the boards: any gap of 45 minutes or more with no takeoff or landing. Dammam's status level is set automatically (halted if a halt is open; disrupted if 8%+ cancelled, 3+ diversions or a halt in the last 6 hours) unless set by hand.
- Escalation events come from strikes.json; each has a source link. Economy data are lagged: PortWatch by 4 to 7 days, JODI exports by about two months, EIA spot Brent by several business days; the Brent futures quote is near real time.
- Confidence tags: CONFIRMED = official statement made, or directly checked; CORROBORATED = multiple independent reports consistent with board data; UNVERIFIED = single or social reports not confirmed officially. Claims are attributed to their source.

PREPARED	BOARD DATA AS OF	SOURCES	STATUS	HANDLING	NEXT UPDATE
8:52 AM, Sat 17 Oct	8:52 AM	Flightradar24, GACA, AIS/NOTAC, Reuters, AP, AFP, BBC, Sabq, Gulf News, Arab News, SPA	**RUH Halted · DMM Disrupted**	Open sources · not official	10:00 AM

Sources: Flightradar24, IMF PortWatch, JODI, EIA, Reuters, AP, AFP, SPA · Check your airline · Next update 10:00 AM